Trustworthy Machine Learning

Unlearning 2

Sangdon Park

POSTECH

Motivation

- Certified removal [Guo et al., 2020] assumes strongly convex loss
- Zhang et al. [2024] provides a direct extention of certified removal [Guo et al., 2020]

Definition: Certified Unlearning

Definition ((ε, δ)-Certified Unlearning)

Let

- $\mathcal{D}$ be a training set,
- $\mathcal{D}_u \subset \mathcal{D}$ be an unlearning set,
- $\mathcal{D}_r := \mathcal{D} \setminus \mathcal{D}_u$ be a retain set,
- $\mathcal{H}$ be a hypothesis space,
- $\mathcal{A}$ be a learning algorithm.

Then, $\mathcal{U}$ is an ε-δ certified unlearning algorithm if and only if for all $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{H}$, we have

$$\mathbb{P}\{\mathcal{U}(\mathcal{D}, \mathcal{D}_u, \mathcal{A}(\mathcal{D})) \in \mathcal{T}\} \leq e^{\varepsilon}\mathbb{P}\{\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{D}_r) \in \mathcal{T}\} + \delta$$
$$\mathbb{P}\{\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{D}_r) \in \mathcal{T}\} \leq e^{\varepsilon}\mathbb{P}\{\mathcal{U}(\mathcal{D}, \mathcal{D}_u, \mathcal{A}(\mathcal{D})) \in \mathcal{T}\} + \delta.$$

Key Theorem for Certified Unlearning

Theorem

Let

- $\tilde{w}^* := \arg\min_{w \in \mathcal{H}} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}_r)$,
- $\tilde{w} := \mathcal{U}_{\texttt{remove}}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_u, \mathcal{D})$, *and*
- $\|\tilde{w} - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \leq \Delta$.

Then,

$$\mathcal{U}_{\texttt{hide}}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_u, \mathcal{D}) := \tilde{w} + Y$$

is an ε-δ *certified unlearning if* $Y \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 \mathbf{I})$ *and* $\sigma \geq \frac{\Delta}{\varepsilon}\sqrt{2 \ln \frac{1.25}{\delta}}$.

- The key next step is bounding Δ.
  - With convex models, boudning Δ seems feasible.
  - How about non-convex models?

Algorithm

Certified Unlearning without Convexity

Algorithm: A Single-Step Newton Update

$$\tilde{w}^* \approx \tilde{w} = w^* - H_{w^*}^{-1} \nabla \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r)$$

- $\mathcal{H}$: a set of models
- $\mathcal{D}$: an original training set
- $\mathcal{D}_u \subset \mathcal{D}$: an unleraned set
- $\mathcal{D}_r := \mathcal{D} \setminus \mathcal{D}_u$: a retained set
- $w^* := \arg\min_{w \in \mathcal{H}} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D})$: an optimal trained model – could be a local optimum
- $\tilde{w}^* := \arg\min_{w \in \mathcal{H}} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}_r)$: an optimal unlearned model – could be a local optimum
- $\tilde{w}$: an estimated unlearned model – why? due to the Taylor expansion of $\nabla \mathcal{L}$ at w^*, *i.e.*,

$$\nabla \mathcal{L}(\tilde{w}^*, \mathcal{D}_r) \approx \nabla \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r) + H_{w^*}(\tilde{w}^* - w^*)$$

Thus, $0 = \nabla \mathcal{L}(\tilde{w}^*, \mathcal{D}_r) \approx \nabla \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r) + H_{w^*}(\tilde{w}^* - w^*)$ implies the update rule.

Main Direction

Certified Unlearning without Convexity

Bounding the approximation error $\|\tilde{w} - \tilde{w}^*\|_2$. To this end, we need following assumptions.

Assumption 1

A loss function $\ell(w, x, y)$ has an L-Lipschitz gradient in w, *i.e.*,

$$\|\nabla \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D})\|_2 \leq L.$$

Assumption 2

A loss function $\ell(w, x, y)$ has an M-Lipschitz Hessian in w, *i.e.*,

$$\|H_w - H_{w'}\|_2 \leq M\|w - w'\|_2.$$

Approximation Error

Certified Unlearning without Convexity

Lemma

We have the following approximation error (given previously defined notations):

$$\|\tilde{w} - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \leq \frac{M}{2} \|H_{w^*}^{-1}\|_2 \cdot \|w^* - \tilde{w}^*\|_2^2.$$

- Note that the proof of this lemma does not need global optimality.

Bounding the Norm of the Inverse Hessian

Certified Unlearning without Convexity

Update after Local Convex Approximation

$$\tilde{w} = w^* - (H_{w^*} + \lambda I)^{-1} \nabla \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r)$$

- Intuitively, we approximatly convert the non-convex objective to the strongly convex one.
  - In general, $\|H_{w^*}^{-1}\|_2$ is arbitrarly large.
  - Add a small diagonal, *i.e.*, $\|(H_{w^*} + \lambda I)^{-1}\|_2$, equivalent to the Hessian of the regularized objective, *i.e.*, $\mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}_r) + \frac{\lambda}{2}\|w\|_2^2$
  - At w^*, the regularized objective can be strongly convex for some λ.

Bounding the Norm of $w^* - \tilde{w}^*$

Certified Unlearning without Convexity

Constrained Learning

$$w^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \leq C} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}) \quad \text{and} \quad \tilde{w}^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \leq C} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}_r)$$

- Due to the constraint, we have

$$\|w^* - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \leq \|w^*\|_2 + \| - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \leq 2C$$

- Interestingly, this implies that the distance between the optimial solutions of non-convex loss functoins is bounded.
- C also encodes the distance between $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}_r$.

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Certified Unlearning without Convexity

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- C also encodes the distance between $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}_r$.
- Can you criticize?
  - Can we actually have small C for neural networks (as $\|x\|_2$ is proportional to the dimension of x)?
  - ...

Approximation Error Bound

Main Theorem of This Paper

Theorem

We have

$$\|\tilde{w} - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \leq \frac{2C(MC + \lambda)}{\lambda + \lambda_{min}}.$$

- Recall that
  - $w^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \leq C}$
  - $\tilde{w} = w^* - (H_{w^*} + \lambda I)^{-1} \nabla \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r)$ with $\lambda > \|H_{w^*}\|_2$
  - $\tilde{w}^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \leq C} \mathcal{L}(w^*, \mathcal{D}_r)$
  - λ_{min}: the smallest eigenvalue of H_{w^*}
- A few notes:
  - Can we unlearn with certification from any original model?
  - Is this data-dependent bound?

Efficient Hessian Computation

Proposition

Given x i.i.d. tained samples $\{X_1, \ldots, X_s\}$, we have $\{H_{1,\lambda}, \ldots, H_{s,\lambda}\}$ of the Hessian $H_{w^*} + \lambda I$, where $H_{i,\lambda} := \nabla^2 \mathcal{L}(w^*, X_i) + \lambda I$, let

$$\tilde{H}_{i,\lambda}^{-1} = I + \left(I - \frac{H_{i,\lambda}}{H} \right) \tilde{H}_{i-1,\lambda}^{-1},$$

where $\tilde{H}_{0,\lambda}^{-1} = I$ and $\|\nabla^2 \ell(w^*, x)\| \leq H$ for all $x \in \mathcal{D}_r$. Then, $\frac{\tilde{H}_{s,\lambda}^{-1}}{H}$ is an asymptotic unbiased estimator of the inverse Hessian $(H_{w^*} + \lambda I)^{-1}$.

- Reduces sample complexity, *i.e.*, we need only s samples instead of n samples.
- Is this effective with "data parallelization"?

Membership Inference Attack

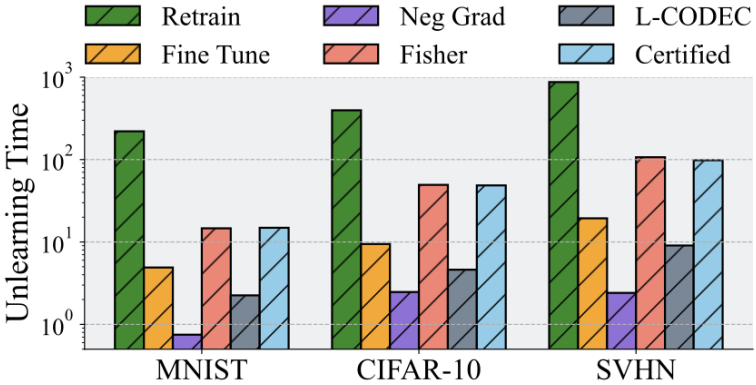
Experiment

Method	MLP & MNIST			AllCNN & CIFAR-10			ResNet18 & SVHN		
	Relearn T	Attack Acc	Attack AUC	Relearn T	Attack Acc	Attack AUC	Relearn T	Attack Acc	Attack AUC
Retrain	25	93.10 $\pm$ 0.33	95.16 $\pm$ 0.47	17	79.82 $\pm$ 0.35	88.71 $\pm$ 0.43	7	90.47 $\pm$ 0.14	93.07 $\pm$ 0.27
Fine Tune	17	93.65 $\pm$ 0.23	95.37 $\pm$ 0.46	14	79.42 $\pm$ 1.05	88.13 $\pm$ 0.66	7	90.63 $\pm$ 0.32	92.96 $\pm$ 0.31
Neg Grad	21	93.73 $\pm$ 0.45	95.42 $\pm$ 0.43	17	78.63 $\pm$ 1.23	87.58 $\pm$ 0.96	9	90.02 $\pm$ 0.13	92.89 $\pm$ 0.22
Fisher	21	93.85 $\pm$ 0.22	95.37 $\pm$ 0.51	14	79.70 $\pm$ 1.03	88.58 $\pm$ 0.76	9	90.47 $\pm$ 0.84	93.13 $\pm$ 0.19
L-CODEC	20	95.05 $\pm$ 0.05	95.31 $\pm$ 0.21	14	83.60 $\pm$ 0.62	92.18 $\pm$ 0.17	7	93.22 $\pm$ 0.35	93.75 $\pm$ 0.54
Certified	24	93.22 $\pm$ 0.46	95.28 $\pm$ 0.50	25	78.00 $\pm$ 1.18	87.22 $\pm$ 1.13	9	88.63 $\pm$ 1.58	92.18 $\pm$ 1.16

- Attack Acc (= Attack F1 score) is as good as retraining.
- Here, Attack means membership inference attacks, *e.g.*,
  - For $\{(z_i, b_i)\}$ where $z_i := (x_i, y_i)$ and $b_i \in \{\text{“}z_i \notin \mathcal{D}_{\text{train}}\text{”}, \text{“}z_i \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{unlearn}}\text{”}\}$, an attacker h wins if $h(z_i)$ correctly predicts b_i

Unlearning Time

Experiment



- Efficient – note that the y-axis is log-scale.

Conclusion

- Proposes a certified unlearning method for deep models.
  - (I guess) Mainly thanks to the bounded optimal solutions, *i.e.,*

$$w^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \le C} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}) \quad \text{and} \quad \tilde{w}^* = \arg\min_{\|w\|_2 \le C} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D}_r).$$

  - The above implies

$$\|w^* - \tilde{w}^*\|_2 \le 2C.$$

- How can we minimize C?
  - Recall that $\min_{\|w\|_2 \le C} \mathcal{L}(w, \mathcal{D})$
  - Recall that $\sigma \ge \frac{2C(MC+\lambda)}{\varepsilon(\lambda+\lambda_{\min})}\sqrt{2\ln\frac{1.25}{\delta}}$
  - Larger $C \to$ larger noise $\sigma \to$ accruacy drop

Reference I

C. Guo, T. Goldstein, A. Hannun, and L. Van Der Maaten. Certified data removal from machine learning models. In *International Conference on Machine Learning*, pages 3832–3842. PMLR, 2020.

B. Zhang, Y. Dong, T. Wang, and J. Li. Towards certified unlearning for deep neural networks. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2408.00920*, 2024.